

The Exact Automation Blueprint Punctual Plumbers Uses to Respond in Minutes, Not Hours

The Problem You Know Too Well

It's 7:47 PM. A homeowner in Ballito messages your WhatsApp: *"Geyser burst. Need someone NOW."*

You're on a job site. Hands dirty. Phone in the bakkie.

By the time you see it at 8:15 PM, they've already called three other plumbers. **Job lost.**

This happens 3-5 times a week for the average KZN trade business.

The Numbers Don't Lie

Metric	Before Automation	After Automation
Avg. response time	4.2 hours	4 minutes
Quote-to-job conversion	23%	41%
After-hours jobs captured	12%	67%
Admin hours/week	8-12 hrs	1.5 hrs

Source: Punctual Plumbers internal data, 6-month comparison

The 3 Automations You Can Build This Week

1. WhatsApp → Instant Quote Acknowledgment (15 min setup)

Tools: WhatsApp Business API (or Twilio) + Make (formerly Integromat)

The Flow:

```
Customer WhatsApps → Make webhook captures → Auto-reply: "Got it! [Name] will call within 15 min" →  
Creates job card in Google Sheet/Airtable → Sends you push notification with address & details
```

Template Message:

"Thanks for reaching out, {{Name}}! 🛠️ We've logged your {{issue}} at {{address}}. [Owner Name] is on a job but will call you within 15 minutes. Reference: JOB-{{timestamp}}"

Why it works: Customer feels heard instantly. You get structured data. Zero manual typing.

2. Quote Follow-Up Sequence That Runs While You Sleep (30 min setup)

Tools: Make + Gmail/Outlook + WhatsApp

The Flow:

```
Quote sent (via email/WhatsApp) → Make watches for "Sent" status →  
Day 1, 10 AM: "Hi {{Name}}, just checking – any questions on the quote for {{job}}?"  
Day 3, 2 PM: "Hey {{Name}}, quote for {{job}} expires Friday. Happy to adjust scope if needed."  
Day 5, 9 AM: "Last call on {{job}} quote – locking in material prices today. Let me know?"
```

Pro tip: Include a "Book Site Visit" Calendly link in every follow-up.

Result: Punctual Plumbers recovered **R187K in otherwise-lost quotes** in month 1.

3. After-Hours Lead Capture + Morning Handoff (20 min setup)

Tools: WhatsApp Business away message + Make + Google Sheets

The Flow:

```
After 6 PM / Before 7 AM: WhatsApp auto-reply triggers →  
"Thanks for messaging! We're off-site but your request is logged.  
We'll call by 8 AM. For emergencies, call [emergency number]."  
→ Make captures: name, number, message, timestamp →  
Adds to "Morning Call List" Google Sheet →  
You open sheet at 7 AM, tap-to-call each lead
```

Bonus: Add a "Urgency" dropdown in the sheet (Emergency / Today / This Week) so you prioritize.

Your "Start This Week" Checklist

Task	Time	Done?
Set up WhatsApp Business auto-reply (after-hours)	10 min	☐
Create Make account (free tier = 1,000 ops/mo)	5 min	☐
Build Webhook → Auto-reply scenario	15 min	☐
Build Quote Follow-Up scenario	30 min	☐
Build Morning Handoff sheet + scenario	20 min	☐
Test with 3 real leads	30 min	☐
Total	~1.5 hours	

The "No-Code" Stack We Recommend (All Free to Start)

Need	Tool	Free Tier
Automation engine	Make	1,000 ops/mo
Database/Job board	Airtable	1,000 records
WhatsApp messaging	Twilio / WhatsApp Business App	\$0 (app) / pay-per-msg (API)
Scheduling	Calendly	Free
Forms/Quote builder	Tally.so	Unlimited free

Monthly cost at scale: ~R500-800/mo (Twilio API + Make Pro)

Want Us to Build It For You?

You've got a business to run. Pipes to fix. Geysers to replace.

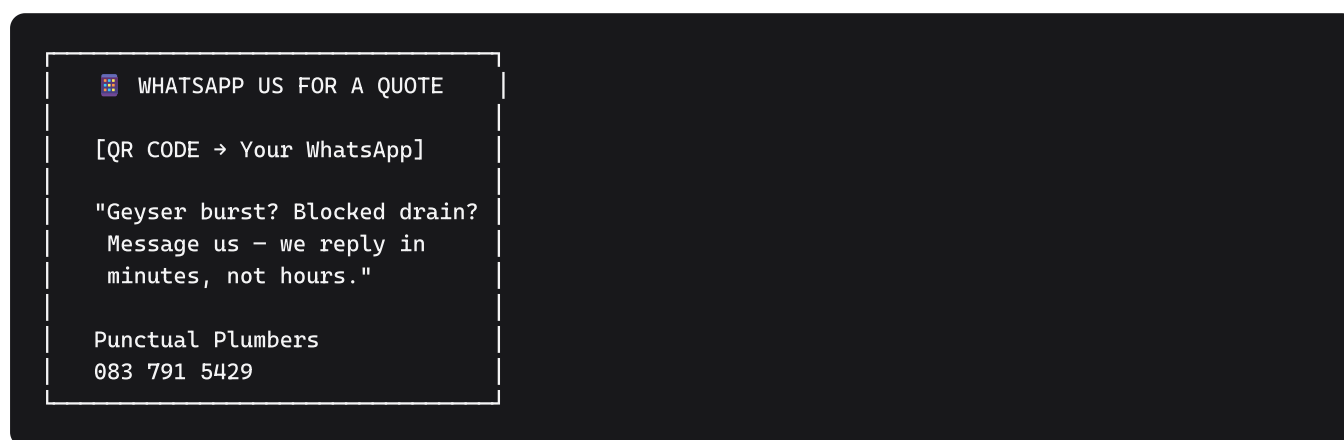
Book a free 30-minute AI Strategy Call and we'll: 1. Audit your current lead flow (15 min) 2. Show you the exact Make scenarios pre-built for trades (10 min) 3. Give you a copy-paste deployment plan — or we build it turnkey (5 min)

No pitch. No pressure. Just a clearer path to more jobs.

→ **[Book Your Free Call Here](#)**

One More Thing: The WhatsApp QR Card

Print this. Stick it on your bakkie. Put it on every invoice.



Generates 2-3 qualified leads/week per vehicle. Cost: R150 for laminated cards.